REFLECTION

فَاجْعَل لِّي صَرْحًا

Pharaoh's Tower

Al-Qasas 28:38

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REFLECTION

Pharaoh's Tower

Arrogance in Surah Al-Qasas (28:38)

In Surah Al-Qasas (28:38), Pharaoh speaks to his court:

وَقَالَ فِرْعَوْنُ يَا أَيُّهَا الْمَلَأُ مَا عَلِمْتُ لَكُم مِّنْ إِلَٰهٍ غَيْرِي فَأَوْقِدْ لِي يَا هَامَانُ عَلَى الطِّينِ فَاجْعَل لِّي صَرْحًا لَّعَلِّي أَطَّلِعُ إِلَىٰ إِلَٰهِ مُوسَىٰ وَإِنِّي لَأَظُنُّهُ مِنَ الْكَاذِبِينَ ﴿٣٨﴾

"Pharaoh said: Chiefs, I know of no god for you other than me. So, Haman, fire bricks of clay for me and build me a tall tower, so that I may look up at the God of Moses; though I think he is a liar."

What the ayah shows

- **Pride:** مَا عَلِمْتُ لَكُم مِّنْ إِلَٰهٍ غَيْرِي "I know of no god for you but me". Elsewhere he says it outright: أَنَا رَبُّكُمُ الْأَعْلَىٰ "I am your lord most high" (79:24).
- **Mockery:** a tower of baked bricks to "look at" the God of Musa, as if Allah were a thing up in the sky to be reached by building higher.

- **A precise detail:** أَوْقِدْ ... عَلَى الطِّينِ "light a fire on the clay", that is, fire bricks. The Qur'an gives even the building method of his tower.

Pharaoh had power, wealth and engineers. He drowned, and Allah said to him:

فَالْيَوْمَ نُنَجِّيكَ بِبَدَنِكَ لِتَكُونَ لِمَنْ خَلْفَكَ آيَةً

"Today We will preserve your body, so that you may be a sign for those after you" (10:92).

Thank You, Allah, for making us among the Muslims, and peace and blessings on Your noble Messenger who brought us the message.

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